IMPERIAL
Learning Analytics

Data CoLab

MINI MONSTER HACK

STUDENT GUIDE

Wednesday 28 October 2026

Queens Tower Rooms, South Kensington







HUNT > BUILD + TEST 1 > PREDICT > SHOWCASE

KEEP THIS GUIDE WITH YOU

Use this booklet for the event flow, submission process, judging and raffle rules. Keep the separate Monster Guide alongside it while you work.

<LEARN. DISCOVER. TRANSFORM.>

IMPERIAL
Learning Analytics | Data CoLab

MINI MONSTER HACK

EVENT AGENDA

Wednesday 28 October 2026 | Queens Tower Rooms, South Kensington

HUNT > BUILD + TEST 1 > PREDICT | Move through the challenge at your team's pace

12:45-13:10
REGISTRATION + TEAM CHECK-IN
Check in, find your table, rebalance incomplete teams and get connected to Teams.

13:10-13:30
MAIN BRIEFING
Challenge story, monster types, submissions, raffle entries and the checking process.

13:30-14:30
CHALLENGE BEGINS
Start with HUNT, then move on once your team is checked and ready.

14:30-14:45
BREAK
Drinks available. Get up, reset and step away from your laptop for 15 minutes.

14:45-16:40
CHALLENGE CONTINUES
HUNT > BUILD + TEST 1 > PREDICT. Hints may be released if teams need them.

16:40-17:00
FINAL SUBMISSIONS + CHECKS
Make sure all required files are submitted. Pizza arrives at around 16:45.

17:00-17:35
PIZZA + JUDGING
Pizza served while submissions, accuracy and showcase work are reviewed.

17:35-17:50
RESULTS + AWARDS + RAFFLE
1st and 2nd to Escape, Best Monster Detector, Best Showcase and raffle draw.

17:50-18:00
CLOSE
Certificates, Data CoLab opportunities, thank you and finish.

READY FOR CHECKING
Post "Ready for checking" in the main Teams checking thread when a stage is complete.
The Teams post timestamp is the official completion time - so nobody loses their place while staff are busy.

THE CHALLENGE

Investigate, build, test - and, if you reach it, predict.

THE PROBLEM

Something strange is hiding in the Learning Analytics data.

Among thousands of normal activity records are unusual behaviours, anomalies and monsters. Your team must work out what gives them away, turn your discoveries into a repeatable detector, and test whether it works on data you have not seen before.



STAGE 1

HUNT

Explore the 80% training dataset manually. Identify as many monsters as you can and explain what gave them away.



STAGE 2

BUILD

Turn what you learned into a repeatable Monster Detector: rules, code, workflow or model.



STAGE 3

TEST 1

Run your detector on the unseen 10% test data. Record the P_IDs and monster types it finds.



STAGE 4

PREDICT

If you reach this stage, use data available only up to 14 Nov 2023 to spot early warning signs of future behavioural monsters.



STAGE 5

SHOWCASE

Show the clearest, strongest piece of work your team produced: result, visual, model output or interface.



USE THE SEPARATE MONSTER GUIDE

It tells you what to find. Your team still decides how to find it. Hints may be released if teams need them.

IMPERIAL
Learning Analytics | Data CoLab

MINI MONSTER HACK

SUBMIT. POST. GET CHECKED. MOVE ON.

Private channel for files. Main Teams checking thread for the queue.

1. SAVE YOUR WORK

Work from your team copies. Save files in your private team channel - do not overwrite the master templates.

2. COMPLETE THE STAGE

Save the relevant Excel workbook, slides and code/output. Full P_ID lists belong in Excel.

3. POST READY FOR CHECKING

Post in the main checking thread, for example: "Team G - HUNT ready for checking".

4. WE CHECK IN TIMESTAMP ORDER

Your Teams post time is the official completion time, so you do not lose your place if staff are busy.

IF SOMETHING IS MISSING

Fix it, then post “Ready for checking” again. The new Teams post becomes the valid timestamp.

AT EACH CHECKPOINT

HUNT

SUBMIT / SHOW

HUNT Excel + HUNT slide(s).

NEXT Correct HUNT P_IDs are released privately after checking.

BUILD / TEST 1

SUBMIT / SHOW

Working detector + code + TEST 1 Excel + TEST slide(s).

NEXT Continue once checked.

PREDICT

SUBMIT / SHOW

If completed: PREDICT Excel + slide(s) + code.

NEXT Prepare final showcase / FINAL ready post.

FINAL READY TIMESTAMP

Only the FINAL ready timestamp is used to calculate 1st and 2nd to Escape. HUNT, TEST 1 and PREDICT timestamps are kept as an audit trail.

AWARDS, CERTIFICATES & RAFFLE

Awards give recognition and extra raffle entries - the raffle is the only prize.

CERTIFICATES FOR EVERYONE

Every participant receives a Mini Monster Hack certificate. If your team wins an award, that award will be shown on your certificate.

1ST TO ESCAPE

+10 raffle entries

Earliest valid FINAL Ready for Checking timestamp.

2ND TO ESCAPE

+5 raffle entries

Second valid FINAL Ready for Checking timestamp.

BEST MONSTER DETECTOR

+10 raffle entries

Highest official TEST 1 accuracy score.

BEST SHOWCASE

+10 raffle entries

Judges' choice for the strongest overall showcase.

BEST SHOWCASE - WHAT THE JUDGES WILL LOOK FOR

- A strong idea or insight
- Clear evidence and explanation
- Quality of technical work
- Creativity / usefulness

HOW RAFFLE ENTRIES WORK

CHECKPOINT ENTRIES

+1 HUNT slide(s)
+1 HUNT Excel
+1 detector shown running
+1 working detector code
+1 TEST 1 slide(s)
+1 TEST 1 Excel
+1 PREDICT slide(s)
+1 PREDICT Excel
+1 PREDICT code

BONUSES

+1 Most correct monsters - HUNT
+1 All true monsters found - HUNT
+1 Most correct monsters - TEST 1
+1 All true monsters found - TEST 1
+1 per spooky / Halloween team member
+10 1st to Escape
+5 2nd to Escape
+10 Best Monster Detector
+10 Best Showcase

ONLY PRIZE: 4 x £50 VOUCHERS FOR ONE RAFFLE-WINNING TEAM

Awards do not carry separate prizes - they add raffle entries and are recognised on your certificate.

AWARDS = MORE CHANCES TO WIN THE RAFFLE

The raffle decides the one team that receives the voucher prize.

IMPERIAL
Learning Analytics | Data CoLab

GOOD LUCK,
MONSTER HUNTERS.





REMEMBER

SAVE > SUBMIT > POST READY > GET CHECKED

Your Teams timestamp keeps the checking queue fair.

EVERYONE LEAVES WITH A CERTIFICATE

Awards are recognised on your certificate and add raffle entries.

One raffle-winning team receives 4 x £50 vouchers.

<LEARN. DISCOVER. TRANSFORM.>